



over 50 in the 32 Tests he played in that time. No other opener scored more centuries during that stretch. But the end came swiftly. The final few months saw a marked decline, and his time at the top quietly came to a close.

ROHIT'S TEST CAREER STATS

MATCHES

67

Runs

4301

Average

40.57

100s/50s

12/18

Highest score

212

Rohit belongs to a generation — alongside Virat Kohli, Rahane, Cheteshwar Pujara, Ishant Sharma, and Ravindra Jadeja — that grew up dreaming of the Test cap. And though his body didn't always cooperate at the peak of his Test career, Rohit the batter still scaled some significant highs. He has every reason to walk away satisfied.

Beyond statistics, Rohit has also had to contend with the recurring tag of being a "gifted" or "naturally talented" cricketer.

In that same 2014 interview — just weeks before his record-breaking 264 in an ODI against Sri Lanka — he responded sharply when asked about this label.

With his trademark casual flick of the forearm to his forehead, he countered the idea. "I wasn't gifted," he said. "Everything has come through sheer hard work." He spoke about how much effort it took to make his batting look effortless—especially after transitioning from being an off-spinner.

His on-field nonchalance may sometimes be mistaken for swagger, even a "tapori" vibe in Mumbai cricket slang. But those close to Rohit know his emotional core has remained intact across phases of his career.

Even when competing with Rahane for a place in the XI, their friendship never wavered. After being called up as Yuvraj Singh's replacement for the 2011 West Indies Test series, Rohit told me how difficult it was to take the spot of someone he considered an older brother — even as he longed for that elusive debut. In 2025, the roles had reversed. Rohit had become the elder statesman, looking out for the next generation — firm, yet caring.

As a captain in Tests, Rohit may not have had the same impact he did in limited-overs formats. But for a boy from Borivali who once dreamed more about donning India's whites than owning luxury cars, 67 Test caps and five years of elite batting represent a fulfilling journey.

Whether his Test career is seen as a case of glass half full or half empty will remain a matter of perspective. What's certain is that Rohit gave it enough for the conversation to be worth having.

« Beyond statistics, Rohit has also had to contend with the recurring tag of being a "gifted" or "naturally talented" cricketer »